



TECHMINDS ACADEMY

HTML Mastery

Web Foundations Curriculum · Beginner to Confident

A structured 12-week programme for students with no prior coding experience. From opening a text editor for the first time to building a complete, validated, accessible website.

12 Weeks	5 Stages	55+ Lessons	8 Projects	0 Prerequisites
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HTML Structure · Text & Lists · Links & Navigation · Images & Tables · Forms · Semantic HTML5 · Capstone Website

LEARNING PATHWAY

Programme Overview

Stage	Focus	Duration	Level
Stage 1	HTML Foundations — structure, tags, text	3 weeks	Beginner
Stage 2	Links, Lists & Navigation	2 weeks	Beginner
Stage 3	Images, Media & Tables	2 weeks	Intermediate
Stage 4	Forms & User Input	2 weeks	Intermediate
Stage 5	Semantic HTML5, SEO & Capstone	3 weeks	Advanced

CURRICULUM RATIONALE

Key Decisions Explained

Why HTML first?	HTML is the skeleton of every website. Before a student learns CSS or JavaScript, they must understand structure. A student who skips HTML foundations will struggle to debug or reason about web pages for the rest of their career.
Why 12 weeks for HTML?	Most beginners rush through HTML in a week and miss the depth. This curriculum takes time to cover accessibility, semantic meaning, forms, and validation — skills that separate junior developers from strong ones.
Why build projects every week?	Reading about HTML without writing it creates an illusion of understanding. Every week ends with a project the student builds from scratch, reinforcing the lesson through real practice.
What comes after this course?	This course feeds directly into CSS Fundamentals, then JavaScript Basics. Students who complete this programme are fully ready for the next stage of the TechMinds web development track.

HTML Foundations

Understanding the web and writing your first HTML page

This stage introduces the student to the web and how browsers work. There is no prior knowledge assumed — not even typing skills. By the end of Week 3, the student will have built and viewed a real web page on their own computer using nothing but a text editor and a browser.

Week 1

Introduction to the Web & HTML

5 lessons · 5 hrs

- 01 What is the internet? What is a website?
- 02 How browsers read and display HTML
- 03 Setting up VS Code and opening your first file
- 04 The HTML document structure: DOCTYPE, html, head, body
- 05 Your first web page — writing and saving index.html
- 06 Opening your page in a browser and viewing the result

PROJECT A simple 'About Me' page — name, a sentence about yourself, saved and opened in a browser

Week 2

Tags, Elements & Attributes

5 lessons · 5 hrs

- 01 What are HTML tags? Opening and closing tags explained
- 02 What are elements? Tags vs elements vs content
- 03 What are attributes? Adding information to tags
- 04 The title tag — naming your page in the browser tab
- 05 The meta charset tag — why it matters
- 06 Comments in HTML — writing notes in your code

PROJECT A structured page using at least 6 different tags with correct attributes

Week 3

Headings, Paragraphs & Text Formatting

5 lessons · 5 hrs

- 01 Heading tags h1 through h6 — hierarchy and meaning
- 02 The paragraph tag — structuring written content
- 03 Line breaks with br and horizontal rules with hr
- 04 Bold and italic: strong, em, b, i — when to use each
- 05 Superscript, subscript, and inline code tags
- 06 Whitespace in HTML — why extra spaces are ignored

PROJECT A formatted article page — title, subheadings, paragraphs, and styled text

Stage 02 · Beginner

2 Weeks · Weeks 4 – 5

Links, Lists & Navigation

Connecting pages and organising content

The web is built on links. This stage teaches the student how to connect pages together, build navigation menus, and organise content with lists. By the end, the student will have a multi-page mini website with working navigation.

Week 4

Links & Anchor Tags

5 lessons · 5 hrs

01 The anchor tag — what it is and how it works

02 The href attribute — linking to pages and URLs

03 Relative vs absolute URLs — when to use each

04 Opening links in a new tab with target='_blank'

05 Linking to sections on the same page with #id

06 Email links with mailto: and phone links with tel:

PROJECT

A 2-page website — Home and Contact — linked together with anchor tags

Week 5

Lists & Navigation Menus

5 lessons · 5 hrs

01 Unordered lists with ul and li — bullet points

02 Ordered lists with ol and li — numbered items

03 Nested lists — lists inside lists

04 Definition lists with dl, dt, and dd

05 Building a navigation bar using a ul of anchor links

06 The nav element — marking up navigation semantically

PROJECT

A 3-page mini website with a navigation bar linking all pages

Images, Media & Tables

Adding visuals and structured data to web pages

A web page without visuals is incomplete. This stage introduces images, video, audio, and data tables — the tools needed to build pages that look and feel like real websites. Special attention is given to accessibility: every image must have meaningful alt text.

Week 6

Images & Media

5 lessons · 5 hrs

- 01 The img tag — src, alt, width, and height attributes
- 03 Image file formats: JPEG, PNG, WebP, SVG
- 05 Embedding video with the video tag

- 02 Why alt text matters — accessibility and SEO
- 04 The figure and figcaption elements
- 06 Embedding audio with the audio tag and controls

PROJECT

A photo gallery page — at least 6 images with captions and alt text

Week 7

Tables

5 lessons · 5 hrs

- 01 Table structure: table, tr, td, and th
- 03 The caption element — giving a table a title
- 05 rowspan — merging cells across rows

- 02 thead, tbody, and tfoot — organising table sections
- 04 colspan — merging cells across columns
- 06 When to use tables and when not to

PROJECT

A student results table — subjects, scores, grades, with merged header cells

Forms & User Input

Building interactive forms that collect data

Forms are how users interact with websites — signing up, logging in, placing orders, sending messages. This stage covers every type of form input and teaches the student how to structure forms correctly, label them accessibly, and use HTML5 validation.

Week 8

Form Basics & Input Types

5 lessons · 6 hrs

01 The form element — action and method attributes

02 Text, email, password, and number inputs

03 The label element — linking labels to inputs

04 Placeholder text and default values

05 The submit button — input type submit vs button

06 Date, time, color, range, and file input types

PROJECT

A user registration form — name, email, password, date of birth, submit button

Week 9

Advanced Inputs & Validation

5 lessons · 6 hrs

01 Checkbox inputs — selecting multiple options

02 Radio buttons — selecting one option from a group

03 The select dropdown and option elements

04 The textarea element — multi-line text input

05 HTML5 validation: required, minlength, maxlength, pattern

06 Grouping form fields with fieldset and legend

PROJECT

A course enrolment form — personal details, course selection, checkboxes, and validation

Stage 05 · Advanced

3 Weeks · Weeks 10 – 12

Semantic HTML5 & Capstone

Writing meaningful HTML and building a complete website

The final stage elevates the student from someone who writes HTML to someone who writes good HTML. Semantic elements, SEO meta tags, and accessibility best practices are covered. The stage closes with a capstone project — a complete, multi-page website built from scratch.

Week 10 Semantic HTML5 Elements

5 lessons · 6 hrs

- 01 What is semantic HTML and why it matters
- 02 header, main, footer — page-level landmarks
- 03 article vs section vs div — choosing the right element
- 04 aside — sidebars and supplementary content
- 05 The address element and contact information
- 06 time, mark, abbr, and other inline semantic elements

PROJECT Rewrite a non-semantic div-heavy page using correct semantic HTML5 elements

Week 11 SEO, Meta Tags & Accessibility

5 lessons · 6 hrs

- 01 Meta tags: description, keywords, author
- 02 The viewport meta tag — mobile-ready pages
- 03 Open Graph tags — how pages look when shared on social media
- 04 The lang attribute and why it matters for screen readers
- 05 ARIA roles — making pages accessible to assistive technology
- 06 HTML validation — checking your code with the W3C validator

PROJECT Add full meta tags, Open Graph, and ARIA landmarks to an existing page

Week 12 Capstone Project

6 sessions · 10 hrs

- 01 Planning a website — sitemap, pages, and content
- 02 Building the Home page — hero, nav, sections, footer
- 03 Building the About page — semantic structure and images
- 04 Building the Services or Portfolio page
- 05 Building the Contact page — form with full validation
- 06 Final review — validation, accessibility check, and submission

PROJECT A complete 4-page website: Home, About, Services/Portfolio, Contact — fully semantic and validated

ASSESSMENT & COMPLETION

How Students Are Evaluated

Component	Description	Weight
Weekly Projects (×8)	Page or feature built from scratch at end of each week	40%
Stage Assessments (×5)	Short quiz and code review at end of each stage	30%
Capstone Website	Complete 4-page website — validated, semantic, accessible	30%

LEARNING OUTCOMES

What Students Can Do on Completion

On completing this programme, the student will be able to:

- Write clean, valid HTML5 from scratch without referencing any guide
- Structure any web page correctly using semantic elements
- Build working navigation menus and multi-page websites
- Add images, video, audio, and data tables to web pages
- Build complete, accessible forms with HTML5 validation
- Apply SEO meta tags and Open Graph to any page
- Use ARIA roles and landmarks for screen reader accessibility
- Validate HTML using the W3C validator and fix all errors
- Build and submit a complete 4-page capstone website

TOOLS & RESOURCES

Everything the Student Needs

Tool	Purpose	Cost
VS Code	Primary code editor for writing HTML	Free
Live Server (VS Code extension)	Auto-refreshes the browser on every file save	Free
Google Chrome	Primary browser for viewing and inspecting pages	Free
Chrome DevTools	Inspect and debug HTML structure in the browser	Built-in
W3C Validator	Check HTML for errors and standards compliance	Free
GitHub	Version control and portfolio hosting via GitHub Pages	Free

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